

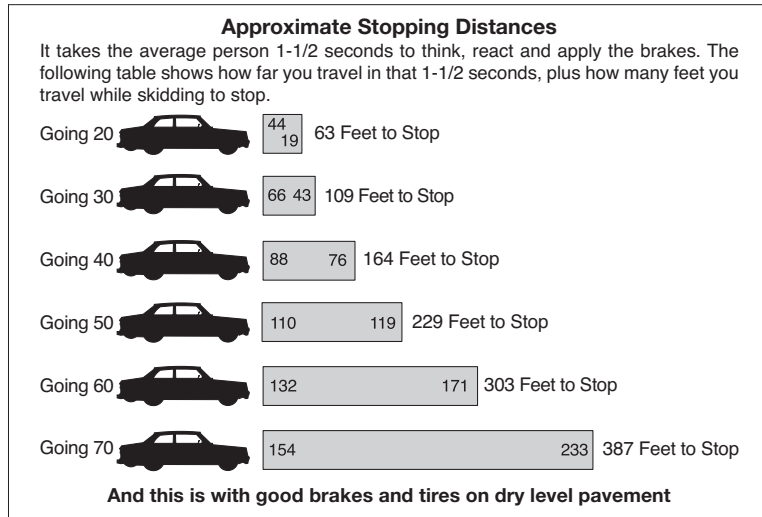
Chapter 8: Speed and Speed Limits

Speed

Generally, you should drive at the same speed as the main stream of traffic and always be aware of how fast you are traveling. You must always obey the speed limit and you should consider these best practices below:

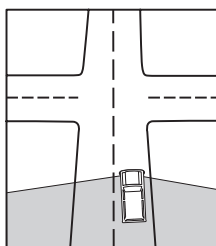
1. You should keep a safe distance between your car and the one in front of you. The faster you drive, the greater the distance you should keep from the car ahead of you. For speeds 30 mph or less, the minimum time between your car and the one in front of you is 2 seconds with good road conditions. For speeds above 30 mph, maintain a 4 second gap between cars during good road conditions. During periods of poor road conditions, allow more time. Using a four-second following interval is the best practice for a beginning or less experienced driver.

Special Note:
When the vehicle ahead of you passes a fixed object and you reach the same fixed object in less than two seconds, you are following too closely.

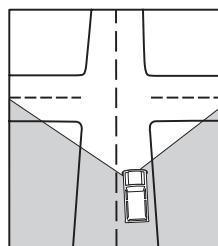


2. You should adjust your speed and following distance according to your physical condition and the conditions of the vehicle and road. If you are tired or not feeling well, do not drive. Never force yourself to drive.
3. You should know when to slow down and increase the following distance.
 - a. Slow down and increase the following distance when the road is wet. Many drivers find out too late what a small amount of rain can do. Roads become slippery when wet, making your car harder to control. Slow down and make sure you have complete control of the situation at all times.
 - b. Slow down and increase the following distance when the road is crowded.
 - c. Slow down and increase the following distance when your vision is limited. You should always be able to stop within the distance you can see ahead of your car. In the dark or in bad weather, do not over-drive your range of vision.

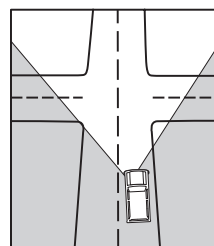
Speed Reduces Your Field of Vision



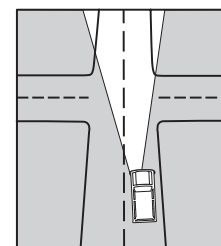
Stationary
Field of vision is 180 degrees or more



20 MPH
Field of vision reduced to about 2/3



40 MPH
Field of vision reduced to about 2/5



60 MPH
Field of vision reduced to about 1/5